

for a website design) dependent and the other is the stand-alone type which will work with any given framework or simply put, is not specific to any framework. Carbon is a good example of a stand-alone package in Laravel. It is used to get your time and date stamps on the application. Packages like Carbon exist to make your life easier. They take care of all these details on the backend and provide you with a smooth user interface minus any date or time hiccups.

Once you decide or select the packages you need to develop your website, you will need to configure and load a list of “service providers”. Service providers essentially are to Laravel what mitochondria are to a living cell. They are the central power house. Their main function is bootstrapping. To generalise the term bootstrapping, it simply means registering things. This could be registering event listeners, service container bindings or even middleware.

The key to adding functionality, saving time and costs would be to identify the type of packages needed for your project. One of the main functions of packages is to boost the Laravel application. These are exclusive to Laravel and irrespective of what function they serve (route controllers, etc.). Packages can easily be installed and uninstalled at any time.

There are thousands of Laravel specific packages that are constantly being developed to help the standard framework user. Let’s have a look at some of the more popular ones.

Cashier

What cashier does ideally is create a good and fluid interface for Braintree or Stripe to work on. While Stripe focuses on providing banking as well as fraud prevention infrastructure, Braintree’s rise to popularity has to do with its parent company - PayPal which has a reputation to speak of. Given PayPal’s global footprint, Braintree makes it easier for companies to accept international payments.

Both systems work on credit card billing subscription models, but Braintree supports PayPal. While making the choice between Stripe and Braintree, you should try and keep the following points in mind -

- Unlike Stripe, Braintree can support PayPal
- Braintree is incapable of computing and supporting percentage based discounts.
- Braintree cannot support the decrement or increment systems on subscriptions.